

DIGITAL CREATIVE PLANNING GUIDE

Real-world examples of website, product design, development, and retainer combinations to help you find your own starting point

A Note on How to Use This Guide

Instead of just listing menus, this guide walks through how client needs actually turn into a scope, a bundle, and a price. If you see services you need in one of these, that's a good place to start the conversation. Every example here can be adjusted, combined, split apart, or scaled up or down. None of it is a fixed menu you have to fit into.

There are four parts: Part 1 covers websites, Part 2 covers Product Design & Development, Part 3 covers Creative & Content Writing, and Part 4 covers ongoing maintenance and marketing retainers.

This guide does not modify the terms of the Retainer & Project Agreement or any signed project proposal. Where this guide and a signed agreement conflict, the signed agreement governs. All pricing shown reflects starting rates from the current Agreement and is subject to change; final scope and price for any project are confirmed only in a written proposal.

PART 1: Example Website Project Builds

The examples below show common ways to combine Website Packages and Feature & Functionality Add-Ons to fit a typical need and budget. Feel free to swap, add, or remove any feature from these examples to better fit your situation.

The Solo Professional

For a business that just needs a professional online presence such as a menu, a service list, or basic info without extra functionality.

- Starter Site (\$3,000 - \$4,500)
- No add-ons beyond what's included in the package

Typical total: ~\$3,000 - \$4,500

Good for: a single-location service business, a solo professional, or a business validating an idea before investing further.

The Local Favourite

For a business that wants a starter-level footprint but needs some extra features.

- Starter Site (\$3,000 - \$4,500)
- + Dynamic contact/inquiry form (\$250)
- + FAQ accordion system (\$200)

Typical total: ~\$3,500 - \$5,000

Good for: a business that gets a lot of repeat questions, or needs inquiries routed to different staff/departments.

The Boutique Retailer

For a business that sells physical products, offers services with a “before/after” element, or wants to show off its work.

- Business Site (\$4,500 - \$7,500)
- + Image gallery with lightbox viewer (\$350, up to 20 images)
- + Hero slideshow/promotional animation system (\$300, up to 6 slides)

Typical total: ~\$5,000 - \$8,000

Good for: contractors, salons, restaurants, boutique retailers, photographers.

The Portfolio-Driven Business

For a business whose core need is letting visitors browse and filter products, services, or past work.

- Business Site (\$4,500 - \$7,500)
- + Custom searchable/filterable catalogue or portfolio system (\$1,200, up to 25 items/3 filters)
- + Image gallery with lightbox viewer (\$350)

Typical total: ~\$6,000 - \$9,000

Good for: real estate-adjacent businesses, product resellers, designers/artists, multi-service providers.

The Growing Business

For an established business that wants a complete, feature-rich site in one build.

- Professional Site (\$7,500 - \$15,000+)
- + Custom catalogue/portfolio system (\$1,200)
- + Image gallery with lightbox viewer (\$350)
- + Hero slideshow (\$300)
- + FAQ accordion system (\$200)
- + Dynamic inquiry form (\$250)

Typical total: ~\$9,800 - \$17,300+ depending on scope

Good for: businesses ready to consolidate their full offering into one polished, scalable site.

The Booking & Ordering Business

For a business that needs to sell online or take bookings directly through the site.

- E-Commerce / Custom package (from \$10,000, quoted on scope)
- + Booking/scheduling system integration, if applicable (from \$800)
- + Membership or login system, if applicable (from \$1,500)

Typical total: Quoted individually - highly dependent on catalogue size, payment integration, and account features

Good for: retailers selling online, service businesses taking appointments, membership-based businesses.

The Business Ready for a Refresh

For a business with an outdated or underperforming site that needs a refresh of look, structure, or pages.

- Major page redesign, per page (\$600 base + \$150 - \$300 per page for new custom components)
- + New website page(s), if expanding beyond the current structure (\$300+/page)
- + Website speed & performance optimization (\$200+)
- + SEO optimization of existing pages (\$100/page)

Typical total: ~\$1,000 - \$3,000 depending on number of pages and complexity

Good for: a business that likes their current site's foundation but needs it modernized, faster, or restructured without starting from scratch. Larger revamps are typically better scoped as a Business Site or Professional Site rebuild instead.

Choosing Between a Revamp and a Full Rebuild

As a general guideline, if more than half the site's pages need new layouts, new functionality, or a new structure, a full package rebuild (Starter/Business/Professional) is usually more cost-effective than accumulating individual redesign and add-on charges page by page. We're happy to advise on which approach fits during scope review.

PART 2: Example Product Design & Development Builds

UX/UI Design, Product Design, and Development are treated as distinct, sequential stages: UX Design covers research, structure, and interaction (flows, wireframes); Product Design covers the visual, systemized, production-ready layer built on top of it (UI design, design systems); and Development turns an approved design into a real, shipped application. The examples below show common ways clients combine these stages depending on where a project starts and how far it needs to go.

Prices reference the UX Design, Product Design, Combined/End-to-End, and Product Design & Development services in the current Retainer & Project Agreement, along with the Product Design & Development Bundles. See that document for full details and current rates.

The Startup Founder

For a founder or team that needs to know the flows and structure work before spending on visual polish.

- Discovery & UX research, up to 3 sessions (\$750)
- + User flow mapping, 2 - 3 flows (\$300/flow)
- + High-fidelity wireframes, 8 - 10 screens (\$275/screen)

Typical total: ~\$3,550 - \$4,400 priced individually, or \$3,900 flat as the Discovery & Flow Bundle (fixed scope: 3 flows, 10 screens) [saves \$500]

Good for: an early-stage product, a new app concept, or a founder who wants a validated structure before committing to a visual design phase.

The Team Picking Up Mid-Project

For a client who already has flows or wireframes in hand (from us or elsewhere) and needs the production-ready visual layer.

- Visual & UI design, high-fidelity, 10 screens (\$325/screen)
- + Design system starting scope (from \$3,500)

Typical total: \$6,750+ priced individually, or \$6,000 flat as the UI & Design System Bundle [saves \$750]

Good for: a team that's done its own discovery work, or is picking up a project after an in-house or external UX phase.

The SaaS Founder

For a client who wants one provider handling research through a clickable prototype (end-to-end) before committing to a build.

- Discovery & UX research, up to 3 sessions
- + User flow mapping, up to 3 flows
- + High-fidelity wireframes, up to 10 screens
- + Visual & UI design for those screens
- + Interactive prototype, up to 8 connected screens

Typical total: \$7,950 flat as the Prototype Bundle [saves \$1,500 vs. individual pricing]

Good for: a client who wants a complete, on-brand, clickable prototype ready to test with users or pitch to stakeholders/investors. Ends at the prototype; no code is shipped to production, and a design system is not included.

The Investor-Ready Founder

For a client who needs a convincing and interactive walkthrough rather than a fully built product.

- High-fidelity wireframes, 6 - 8 key screens (\$275/screen)
- + Visual & UI design for those screens (\$325/screen)
- + Interactive prototype, up to 8 connected screens (from \$1,800)

Typical total: ~\$5,400 - \$6,600+

Good for: a founder preparing for a funding round, or a team validating a concept with stakeholders before committing to full development.

The Scaling Product Team

For a client whose product is already designed but needs consistency and speed as it grows.

- Design system, component library, style guide & documentation (from \$3,500)
- + Visual & UI design for any net-new screens as needed (\$325/screen)

Typical total: From \$3,500, scoped by component count

Good for: an established product team standardizing before scaling, onboarding new designers/developers, or preparing for a multi-platform expansion.

The Quick Add-On

For a client who just needs a defined batch of screens designed and not a full engagement.

- High-fidelity wireframes, 3 - 5 screens (\$275/screen)
- + Visual & UI design, 3 - 5 screens (\$325/screen)

Typical total: ~\$1,800 - \$3,000

Good for: adding a new flow to an existing product, designing a single feature, or a client testing the waters before a larger engagement.

The Founder Ready to Build

For a client who already knows this isn't just a design exercise and wants a working application at the end of it.

- Discovery & UX research, up to 3 sessions, up to 3 user flows, and up to 10 high-fidelity wireframe screens, plus Visual & UI design for those screens - bundled at \$6,750 flat as the Product Launch Bundle (saves \$900 vs. individual pricing)
- + Product Design & Development build (Foundation tier or above), scoped and quoted separately, starting at \$10,000

Typical total: From \$16,750 up, exact development price confirmed in a written proposal after Discovery

Good for: a founder or small team ready to go from a validated idea to a shipped, production-ready web or mobile application; the full path this studio was built to handle, from research through a live product.

Choosing Between Menu Items and a Bundle

As a general guideline, if a project needs three or more of Discovery, flows, wireframes, UI design, and a prototype together, one of the Product Design & Development Bundles will almost always cost less than selecting those items individually and locks in the combined scope up front. Smaller or single-discipline needs (just wireframes, just a prototype, just a design system) are typically better suited to menu pricing.

Development itself is always scoped and quoted separately from any design bundle because build complexity varies too much to price as a flat add-on; we're happy to advise on which approach fits during scope review.

PART 3: Example Creative & Content Writing Builds

Words carry as much weight as visuals, so writing is offered at the same range of depth as everything else in this guide; from a single polished page to an ongoing editorial partnership. The examples below show common starting points. Any service from Creative & Content Writing Services can be combined or adjusted to fit the needs of each client.

The New Business Launch

For a business launching a new site (or relaunching an old one) that needs its written voice established from scratch.

- Brand voice guide (\$600)
- + Standard-tier website copywriting, up to 5 pages (\$1,500)
- + Long-form blog post for launch (\$150)

Typical total: \$1,900 flat as the Brand Foundations Writing Bundle [saves \$350]

Good for: a new business, a rebrand, or any site launch where the words need to feel considered and consistent from day one.

The Business Building Authority Over Time

For a business that already has a voice and just needs steady, consistent output to keep proving expertise and staying visible.

- 2 blog posts/mo (\$300/mo)
- + Editing/proofreading, up to 3,000 words/mo (\$120/mo)
- + Brand voice consistency review (\$75/mo)

Typical total: \$425/mo flat as the Ongoing Content Bundle [saves \$70/mo]

Good for: a business that wants ongoing content without hiring in-house, and pairs naturally with any Website Maintenance retainer.

The SaaS Founder Needing Documentation

For a product team whose users need clear help docs, onboarding guides, or internal documentation.

- Technical writing, Standard tier, per page (\$250/page)
- + Additional pages as the docs library grows (\$250/page)

Typical total: Scoped by page count - a typical 10-page onboarding/help centre runs ~\$2,500

Good for: SaaS products, internal tools, or any team that needs documentation to sound as considered as the product itself.

The Business With a Draft Already Written

For a client who has already written something and needs a professional pass before it goes out the door.

- Copy editing, per 1,000 words (\$40/1,000 words)
- + Proofreading final pass, per 1,000 words (\$25/1,000 words)

Typical total: A typical 5,000-word document runs ~\$325 for both passes

Good for: a client who writes well but wants a second, professional set of eyes before something goes public.

The Brand Wanting a Story

For a business or founder who wants something more narrative than a service page such as a founder story, a script for a promotional video, or a piece of long-form storytelling.

- Creative writing / narrative piece, per 1,000 words (\$200/1,000 words)
- + Script or screenplay writing, per page (\$150/page)
- + Narrative/story consulting session, up to 90 minutes (\$175/session)

Typical total: Scoped by format and length

Good for: a promotional video script, a founder's origin story for an About page, or any project where the writing itself is the product.

Choosing Between One-Time Writing and the Ongoing Content Bundle

As a general guideline, a single launch, campaign, or document is almost always better suited to one-time pricing from the menu above. If a business needs writing every month (blog posts, edits, or consistency checks, etc.) the Ongoing Content Bundle typically costs less than the same items purchased individually each month, and it stacks cleanly with any Website Maintenance or Marketing retainer selected elsewhere in this guide.

PART 4: Retainer Guidance for Ongoing Maintenance & Marketing

Once a website is live, the combinations below show common ways clients put together ongoing Monthly Retainer Menu items.

Just need the site kept running and secure

Website Maintenance - Basic Care

Good for a simple site with infrequent changes.

Need regular updates plus visibility

Basic Care + SEO Monitoring & Optimization + Ongoing Marketing Strategy Consultation

See: Essentials Bundle (\$550/mo).

Need content changes plus light promotion

Basic Care + SEO Monitoring & Optimization + Promotional Flyer Subscription (Basic)

See: Foundation Bundle (\$700/mo).

Actively growing and posting regularly

Advanced Care + Social Media posting package (8 posts/mo) + SEO Monitoring & Optimization + Promotional Flyer Subscription (Basic) + Content Calendar (ongoing)

See: Advanced Bundle (\$1,500/mo).

Running ads and need full oversight

Advanced Care + Social Media posting package (12 posts/mo) + SEO Monitoring & Optimization + Promotional Flyer Subscription (Basic) + Content Calendar (ongoing) + Ad Campaign Management (2 active campaigns) + Monthly Performance Report + Priority Support

See: Complete Bundle (\$2,400/mo).

Want ongoing written content alongside any of the above

Any bundle above + Ongoing Content Bundle (Creative & Content Writing, recurring)

The Ongoing Content Bundle (\$425/mo) stacks cleanly on top of any Suggested Starting Bundle or Custom Retainer Selection without affecting its pricing or setup fee waiver.

For anything in between, a Custom Retainer Selection built directly from the Monthly Retainer Menu will always be more precisely fitted than any example above; these are orientation points only, not limits.

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